

HP to Invest Over \$1 Billion in Open Source Cloud Products and Platforms

HP has demonstrated its commitment to open source technologies with the announcement of major investments in open source cloud products and platforms. The company recently announced HP Helion, a portfolio of cloud products and services. HP claims that its new offering will enable organisations to build, manage and consume workloads in hybrid IT environments.

With these offerings, HP is banking on OpenStack technology, an area in which it is a major investor and contributor. Ramachandran V, director, Sales–Cloud Division, said, “We are one of the leading players in the OpenStack consortium. Two of our people are amongst the board of directors for the consortium. So, one can imagine how serious we are about OpenStack technology and about ‘openness’.”

HP Helion incorporates existing HP cloud offerings, new OpenStack technology-based products, and professional and support services under a unified portfolio to help meet customers’ specific business requirements. The new HP Helion cloud products and services join the company’s existing portfolio of hybrid cloud computing offerings, including the next-generation HP CloudSystem, which was recently ranked as the leader in the Forrester Wave report for Private Cloud Solutions(1). The new products include HP Cloud Services Automation (CSA) software for managing hybrid IT environments, HP’s managed virtual private cloud offering and a range of cloud professional services.

The company plans to invest more than US\$ 1 billion over the next two years on cloud-related products and engineering initiatives, professional services and on expanding HP Helion’s global reach. With this announcement, HP has displayed its commitment to OpenStack technology and the delivery of hybrid IT solutions. Explaining this major investment in open source technologies and the cloud, Ramachandran said, “We will make this investment on a global level. HP has bet heavily on the cloud and we have proclaimed this at multiple forums. The cloud is clearly the most important place to be in and we believe that we have the best of solutions, services and transformations possible for enterprises. We have many customers running traditional IT. The road for them is to get on the cloud-enabled model. If we don’t help those customers to transform, and get the outcomes that they are expecting, I don’t think we would be doing justice to the kind of relationships that we have built over many years. So we had to be ready for our customers—for their end-to-end journey onto the cloud, and that is where we felt that we need to have our own products and technologies.

“For the past three years, we have been offering products in this space but the new addition to our portfolio that we are talking about is very unique. This is a cloud deployment tool that is downloadable in a USB drive and can be plugged into a machine.

It has got the desired pre-requisites and it can be set up with just a few clicks. This kind of ease was not possible before this product was launched. We have a complete stack ready for our customers.”

HP has been running OpenStack cloud services at scale in enterprise environments for over three years. Ramachandran adds, “We understand that organisations require solutions that are open, secure and agile. As a founding platinum member of the OpenStack Foundation and a leader in the OpenStack and Cloud Foundry communities, HP has taken a central role in developing technologies that are built to meet enterprise requirements, and to deliver OpenStack technologies and Cloud Foundry-based solutions to the global marketplace.”

The challenges for customers today are not restricted to just getting on the cloud. The challenges include how to manage, control and scale applications in a hybrid environment that spans multiple technology approaches. Aman Dokania, vice president and general manager, Cloud Division, HP Asia Pacific and Japan, states, “HP Helion provides the solutions and expertise customers need to select the right deployment model for their needs, in order to obtain the greatest return on their investment.”

As part of the HP Helion portfolio, the company is introducing several new cloud products and services, including the following.

- **HP Helion OpenStack Community Edition:** This is a commercial product line of OpenStack that is delivered, tested and supported by HP. The community edition is available as a free version that is ideal for proofs of concept, pilots and basic production workloads. An enhanced commercial edition that addresses the needs of global enterprises and service providers will be released in the coming months.
- **HP Helion Development Platform:** A Platform as a Service (PaaS) based on Cloud Foundry, it offers IT departments and developers an open platform to build, deploy and manage applications quickly and easily. HP plans to release a preview version later this year.
- **HP’s OpenStack Technology Indemnification Program:** This program protects qualified customers using HP Helion OpenStack code from third-party patent, copyright and trade-secret infringement claims directed to OpenStack code alone or in combination with Linux code.
- **HP Helion OpenStack Professional Services:** This is a new practice comprising HP’s experienced team of consultants, engineers and cloud technologists to assist customers with cloud planning, implementation and operational needs. 

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